📊 SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 30

Salesforce Dashboards

Complete Guide — Drag-and-Drop Builder, Widgets, Dashboard Filters & Dynamic Dashboards

- 📊 What is a Salesforce Dashboard?
- 🧱 6 Essential Dashboard Widgets
- 📄 Source Report Dependencies
- 🔍 Interactive Dashboard Filters
- 👤 Running User vs. Dynamic Dashboards
- 🛠️ Practical Demo: Sales Performance Dashboard

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL	CORE DOMAIN
30 of Series	~27 Minutes	Intermediate	Executive Visualization

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Course Context

⏱ 0:00 – 1:00

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In Episode 29, we mastered **Salesforce Reports** — learning how to filter, group, summarize, and visualize data in tabular, summary, and matrix formats.

Now step into the shoes of a Vice President of Sales or Service Director: Does an executive have time to open 10 separate report tabs every morning? **Of course not!**

Leaders need a single consolidated screen where they can instantly digest: *Total Revenue*, *Pipeline Health*, *Sales Rep Leaderboards*, *Deals by Stage*, and *Case SLAs*.

This is the purpose of **Salesforce Dashboards** — converting diverse underlying report datasets into an executive cockpit of charts, KPIs, gauges, and tables.

SECTION 2

What is a Dashboard & Why Do We Need Them?

⏱ 1:00 – 3:30

📌 OFFICIAL DEFINITION

A Salesforce Dashboard is a visual, interactive representation of data derived from one or more Source Reports. It presents critical business key performance indicators (KPIs) through graphical widgets (charts, metrics, gauges, tables) assembled on a drag-and-drop canvas.

🚗 THE CAR DASHBOARD ANALOGY

When driving down the highway, you don't inspect the fuel tank valves or battery voltage sensor wires directly. You look at your car's dashboard: a **speedometer needle** (gauge), a **fuel warning light** (metric), and an **engine temperature meter**. A Salesforce Dashboard gives executives the exact same cockpit view of their company's operational health!

SECTION 3 — CORE DISTINCTION

Reports vs. Dashboards

⏱ 3:30 – 5:00

Criterion	📋 Salesforce Report	📊 Salesforce Dashboard
Primary Focus	Detailed, record-level data & calculations	High-level visual summaries & executive KPIs
Data Independence	Queries the database directly using Report Types	Has **no data of its own**; powered by Source Reports
Presentation	Rows, columns, groupings, subtotals	Multi-widget layout (charts, gauges, metrics, tables)
Ideal User	Sales Reps, Support Specialists, Analysts	Managers, Directors, VP Executives, C-Suite
Interactivity	Filtering, editing inline, sorting, exporting	Dashboard Filters, drilling down into source reports

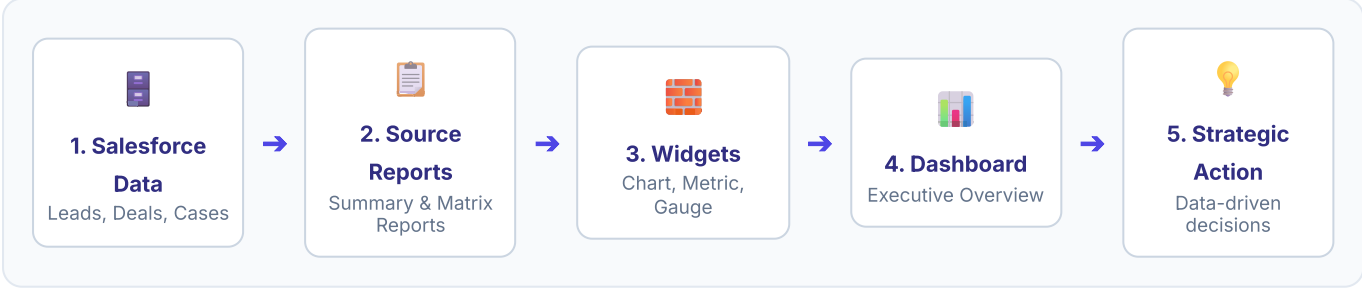
🧠 MEMORY RULE

Report ➔ Analyzes the Data
Dashboard ➔ Visualizes the Story

SECTION 4 — ARCHITECTURE

Dashboard Builder & Source Reports

⏱ 5:00 – 7:45



⚠️ SOURCE REPORT REQUIREMENT

To power a chart or gauge widget on a dashboard, the underlying Source Report **must have at least one grouping** (Summary or Matrix format)! You cannot build charts on raw un-grouped Tabular reports.

SECTION 5

🧱 The 6 Essential Dashboard Widgets

⏱ 7:45 – 12:00

1. Charts

Bar, Column, Donut, Line, Funnel, Scatter. Great for comparing stages or owners.

2. Metric

Displays one big standalone KPI number (e.g., Total Revenue ₹1.5 Cr, Open Cases: 42).

3. Gauge

Color-coded dial (Red, Yellow, Green) tracking current performance against a fixed goal.

4. Table / Lightning Table

Displays top or bottom ranked records (e.g., Top 5 Deals, Top Reps with totals).

5. Text

Add section headings, explanatory notes, or user instructions across the dashboard canvas.

6. Image

Embed company logos, product banners, or departmental graphics for professional branding.

SECTION 6

🔍 Interactive Dashboard Filters

⏱ 12:00 – 14:00

💡 THE POWER OF MULTI-PERSPECTIVE VIEWS

Without dashboard filters, if an executive wants to analyze performance across 4 regions, you would have to build 4 separate dashboards (*North*, *South*, *East*, *West*).

With **Dashboard Filters**, you build **1 single dashboard** and add a `Region` or `Industry` filter dropdown. Users click *"Technology"* and every widget recalculates dynamically!

💡 SALESFORCE LIMIT

You can add up to **3 Dashboard Filters** per dashboard, with up to 50 filter values per filter.

SECTION 7 — SECURITY & ACCESS

Running User vs. Dynamic Dashboards

⏱ 14:00 – 18:00

STANDARD OPTION

1. Fixed Running User

The dashboard runs as one specific user (e.g., *VP of Sales*). Every employee viewing the dashboard sees data based on that running user's security permissions, regardless of their own access!

MODERN OPTION

2. Dynamic Dashboard ("Run as Logged-In User")

Data visibility adapts automatically to whoever opens the dashboard. When Rahul logs in, he sees only his deals; when Priya logs in, she sees only hers!

⚠️ DYNAMIC DASHBOARD CONSTRAINTS TO REMEMBER

- Cannot be saved in personal/private folders.
- Cannot be scheduled for automated email refreshes.
- Users cannot subscribe to dynamic dashboards.
- Orgs have strict license limits (e.g., Enterprise Edition includes up to 5 or 10 dynamic dashboards).

SECTION 8 — STEP-BY-STEP HANDS-ON

Building the Sales Performance Dashboard

⏱ 19:30 – 24:00

1. In **App Launcher**, search for `Dashboards` and open the tab.
2. Click **New Dashboard** → Name: `Sales Performance Dashboard` → Folder: `Sales Dashboards` → Click **Create**.
3. **Widget 1 (Metric):** Click `+ Widget` → choose *Closed Won Opportunities* report → select **Metric** widget displaying `Sum of Amount`. Label: *Closed Won Revenue*.
4. **Widget 2 (Chart):** Click `+ Widget` → choose *Opportunities by Stage* report → select **Funnel Chart** to display conversion through stages.
5. **Widget 3 (Chart):** Click `+ Widget` → choose *Closed Won Deals by Owner* report → select **Horizontal Bar Chart** to compare rep totals.
6. **Widget 4 (Table):** Click `+ Widget` → choose Opportunities report → select **Lightning Table** to list the top 5 high-value deals.
7. **Arrange Canvas:** Drag and resize widgets so KPIs sit along the top row, charts in the middle, and detail tables at the bottom.
8. **Add Filter:** Click `+ Filter` → select `Opportunity Owner` → add values (*Rahul*, *Priya*, *Amit*).
9. **Save & View:** Click **Save** and **Done**. Your live interactive sales dashboard is active! 🎉

SECTION 9 — DECISION MATRIX

When Should You Use a Report vs. a Dashboard?

⏱ 24:00 – 25:00

USE A REPORT WHEN:

Granular Record Analysis

- You need to see individual customer contact details or case numbers.
- You need to export data into Excel/CSV for accounting audits.
- You need complex mathematical summary formulas across rows.

USE A DASHBOARD WHEN:

Executive Overview & Strategy

- Executives want a 1-minute visual snapshot of monthly progress.
- You want to monitor targets against goals using visual gauges.
- You want to consolidate multiple departments (Sales, Service, Marketing) on one screen.

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 30

01

A **Dashboard** provides a high-level, graphical cockpit of critical business metrics powered by underlying Salesforce reports.

02

Every dashboard widget requires a **Source Report** with at least one grouping (Summary or Matrix format).

03

6 Essential Widgets: **Charts**, **Metrics**, **Gauges**, **Tables**, **Text**, and **Images**.

04

Dashboard Filters allow users to toggle dimensions (like Region or Rep) on a single dashboard instead of cloning multiple dashboards.

05

Dynamic Dashboards display data based on the logged-in viewer's security profile rather than a static running user.

06

Remember: **Reports analyze the raw data; Dashboards visualize the strategic story**!

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 31

Next Core Salesforce Admin Feature

Stay tuned as we continue building practical, job-ready Salesforce administration and automation skills!

These notes are an official companion to the YouTube video. Practice hands-on in your Salesforce Developer Org!